Nadeem Wali

UI Engineer & Technical Designer | Unreal Engine 5 (C++ & Blueprint)

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PROFILE

UI engineer and technical designer with a First-Class Honours BA in Games Design and Development and commercial Unreal Engine experience. I design and implement UI and gameplay systems in C++ and Blueprint, build the tools and frameworks behind them, and have shipped work used by thousands of players. I own features end to end, from concept and documentation through implementation, debugging, and optimisation, and I collaborate comfortably across design, art, and engineering. Based in Sheffield.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

UI & Gameplay: CommonUI, UMG, HUD & menu systems, widget animations, gameplay systems, StateTree, movement, balancing & tuning

Tools & Frameworks: Reusable UI frameworks (WireUI), HUD framework (HUDCore), custom PCGEx nodes, custom editor tools, engine source builds

Languages: C++, Blueprint, C#, JavaScript, Lua, HTML/CSS

Engines & Tools: Unreal Engine 5, Unity (familiar), Git, Unreal Insights, Figma

Design: Game design principles, GDD & design documentation, prototyping, playtest-driven iteration

EXPERIENCE

PhantomWire Games | UI Engineer & Technical Designer

2024 – August 2026

Independent Unreal Engine 5 studio; self-directed UI, gameplay, and tools development.

- **COLDLIGHT (UE5 stealth game):** designed and built the UI, a CommonUI HUD, menus, a radial weapon wheel, and the WireUI framework, plus gameplay systems including a StateTree patrol AI, a detection system, and custom movement; authored a full GDD and narrative bible.
- **Nightshift (UE5 racing roguelite):** designed and balanced systems, a roguelite perk-draft progression system and a four-layer racing AI, and built custom PCGEx nodes for procedural content generation.
- **Tools & engine:** built reusable frameworks (WireUI, HUDCore) and custom editor tools, and maintain a custom UE5 engine source build.

Segritude | UI / C++ Developer (Contract)

2025 – Apr 2026

Commercial UE5 title, working within a multidisciplinary team.

- **Built inventory and equipment UI in C++:** armour-slot and furnace UI widgets and an inventory selection manager, plus a live 3D player-preview rendered into the UI using SceneCaptureComponent2D.
- **Implemented supporting gameplay mechanics** for the inventory and equipment systems, and collaborated with designers, artists, and engineers to ship features to spec.

Payday 3 | Independent Mod Developer

2023 – Present, UE4 / UE5

- **Shipped UI and gameplay mods to thousands of players:** reverse-engineered a shipped UE4 title to build and release 20+ mods, reworking a gameplay mechanic and redesigning HUDs for readability and performance.
- **PAYDAY 3 Modkit & PDML:** built a custom UE5.5 editor for cooked game assets and reflected native types; developed CrimeForge's Slate tools and C# automation for mod validation and packaging, plus PDML's runtime framework, in-game Mod Manager and integrated settings for Blueprint logic mods, custom UI and custom-heist foundations.
- **Built HUDCore,** a modular HUD framework other creators now build on; one HUD redesign's improvements were later closely mirrored by an official game patch.

EDUCATION

First-Class Honours, 75.6 (BA), Games Design and Development

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Cineworld:** customer service in a fast-paced, customer-facing environment.
- **Royal Mail:** warehouse operations; reliability and working to deadlines under pressure.